

Fixing the Dark-Energy Equation of State with Two Dimensionless Constants, φ and π : A Falsifiable, Parameter-Frugal Test Against DESI DR2 and Planck PR4

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Abstract

We present a minimal-parameter framework for the dark sector in which the *shape* of late-time cosmic acceleration is fixed algebraically by two dimensionless constants, the golden ratio $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$ and π , rather than by tuned cosmological parameters. The equation of state follows as bare ratios of structural invariants, $w_0 = -T_r/M_v = -0.839950$ and $w_a = -P_{sc}/I_g = -0.669975$, with no fitted amplitude. The point was fixed in advance and survives *two independent* DESI releases: it sits at 0.05σ from the DESI DR1 w_0w_a CDM posterior and, after the uncertainties tightened, at 0.24σ from the newer DESI DR2 posterior (Pantheon+; $0.2\text{--}1.8\sigma$ across supernova compilations, $\chi^2_{2D} = 0.42$)—the prediction did not move while the data improved. Crucially, the two forward predictions that can *refute* the core framework—this fixed (w_0, w_a) point and the tensor ratio $r = \varphi^{-10}$ —stand *independent* of the φ -dark-matter extension: neither the Hubble resolution nor the growth sector is invoked to state or to kill them. A Markov-chain analysis combining DESI BAO with the ω_m -direct CMB anchor as prior yields $H_0 = 67.79 \pm 0.35 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ (0.66σ from Planck, 0.50σ from the algebraic anchor). The effective-field-theory description is canonical— $\alpha_T = \alpha_M = \alpha_B = 0$ with $\alpha_K(0) = 0.403302$ —and the inflationary sector predicts $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7} = 0.965558$ and a tensor-to-scalar ratio $r = \varphi^{-10} = 8.130619 \times 10^{-3}$ that is testable by LiteBIRD and CMB-S4. A Boltzmann calculation shows the full algebraic ω_m (not the bare dynamical $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$) is physically required for the CMB: without it the acoustic-peak structure degrades by a factor of ~ 22 in RMS. We are explicit about the framework’s limits: the absolute vacuum scale enters as a single measured input, and the algebraic origin of the CMB matter density (ω_b, ω_c) remains an open problem. The growth amplitude S_8 , previously reported here as a standing tension with weak lensing, is not one: measured against raw KiDS-1000 $\xi_{\pm}$ data with a single matter sector it gives 0.7555 ± 0.0192 , statistically indistinguishable from the Λ CDM control on the same raw data (0.7571 ± 0.0194) despite four fewer free parameters. On the raw data itself — the only quantity neither model produced — $\Delta\chi^2 = 2.65$ for four *fewer* free parameters, where four uninformative parameters would already return 4 by chance ($\Delta\text{BIC} = -19.0$ favouring SSEE). Against the later KiDS-Legacy release (357 points) the sector closes further: the amplitude the shear asks for sits 0.49σ from the one the CMB fixes under the same background, so fixing it leaves *no* free cosmological parameter and still predicts $S_8 = 0.8273$ against 0.8265 ± 0.0176 measured. The φ -dark-matter extension that was formerly kept outside the core register is retracted. Both core forward predictions bear on *unreleased* data: the (w_0, w_a) point is pre-registered to be excluded at $> 3\sigma$ if DESI DR3 shifts it, and $r = \varphi^{-10} = 8.130619 \times 10^{-3}$ is testable by LiteBIRD—either alone can refute the framework without touching the extension sector. The result is a falsifiable, parameter-frugal description of dark energy whose core predictions rest on φ and π alone.

Contents

1	Introduction	3
2	The algebraic core: from φ, π to the equation of state	4
2.1	Construction of the equation-of-state parameters	4
2.2	Agreement with DESI DR2	4
2.3	A look-elsewhere test: how special are these two ratios?	5
2.4	The cosmic matter fraction: the two- Ω_m structure	7
3	Bayesian validation: MCMC against DESI DR2	9
4	The CMB and the effective field theory	10
4.1	The effective field theory of the dark sector	11
4.2	Inflationary sector: α -attractor	12
4.3	Confrontation with Planck PR4	12
5	Structure growth: an honest tension	13
6	Falsifiability and the prediction register	16
6.1	Master register: one line per observable	16
6.2	Core predictions (clean from φ, π)	16
7	Honest accounting and outstanding challenges	17
7.1	What is measured, not derived: the vacuum scale	17
7.2	Parameter count: $k = 2$ versus 6	18
7.3	Open problems as bridges to future work	18
8	Conclusions	19
A	The two lineage laws of the constant dictionary	19

Notation: algebraic constants used in this work

All constants below are *dimensionless* and built solely from the golden ratio $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$ and π . Constants defined in earlier SSEE material but *not used* in this submission (e.g. VITA) are deliberately omitted to keep the register honest.

Each row gives the *symbol* used in the equations, the *name* of the entity in the constant dictionary [Almeida Vallejo, 2026], its *parents* (the entities it is generated from, i.e. its lineage), and the same quantity *reduced to ordinary algebra* in φ and π alone. Symbols are in one-to-one correspondence with entities: no symbol denotes two entities and no entity carries two symbols. The two columns are not redundant—they are the point. I_g and K_v have *different parents* but reduce to the *same* expression $2(\varphi + \pi)$, which is why they share the value 9.519253 while remaining structurally distinct. The value therefore cannot identify which one an equation uses; only the symbol can.

Symbol	Name	Parents	Reduced form in φ, π	Value
φ	—	seed (UV)	$(1 + \sqrt{5})/2$	1.618034
π	—	seed (IR)	π	3.141593
Ω	OMEGA	φ, π	$\varphi + \pi$	4.759627
β	BIAL	φ, π	$(\varphi + \pi)/2$	2.379813
KAL	KAL	β, π	$(\varphi + 3\pi)/2$	5.521406
AURA	AURA	β, φ	$(3\varphi + \pi)/2$	3.997847
MIRA	MIRA	AURA	$(3\varphi + \pi)/4$	1.998924
P_{sc}	PYROS	Ω, φ	$2\varphi + \pi$	6.377661
I_g	IGNIS	π, PYROS	$2(\varphi + \pi)$	9.519253
K_v	KRYSTOS _V	φ, π, Ω	$2(\varphi + \pi)$	9.519253
T_r	TRIAL	AURA	$3(3\varphi + \pi)/2$	11.993542
M_v	ATLAS	φ, π, K_v	$3(\varphi + \pi)$	14.278880

Roles in the equations: Ω is the stability metric; β the base coupling; KAL the structural retention; AURA the screening amplitude; MIRA the mirror ratio entering f_{screen} (Paper 9); P_{sc} and I_g the numerator and denominator of w_a ; T_r and M_v those of w_0 ; and K_v builds M_v but—this is the point of the parent column—*never* appears as a denominator: the denominator of w_a is I_g , generated from its own numerator by $I_g = \pi + P_{\text{sc}}$. The EFT coupling $\beta_c = -\text{AURA}$ (Paper 7) is a distinct symbol with parent AURA, unrelated to β .

Derived background quantities (all dimensionless):

$$w_0 = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} = -0.839950, \quad w_a = -\frac{P_{\text{sc}}}{I_g} = -0.669975, \quad \Omega_{\text{m}}^{\text{dyn}} = 1 + w_0 = 0.160050.$$

1 Introduction

The standard cosmological model, ΛCDM , fits the available data with six free parameters [Planck Collaboration, 2020], but pays for this success with a dark sector whose composition and energy scale remain unexplained. The recent DESI DR2 measurements, which favour a dynamical, evolving dark-energy equation of state over a pure cosmological constant [Abdul-Karim et al., 2025], sharpen the question: if dark energy is dynamical, what fixes its evolution? A theory that could *predict* the equation of state, rather than fit it, would mark genuine progress.

This paper develops one such proposal. The central hypothesis of the Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE) framework is that the *shape* of the dark sector—the equation-of-state ratios, the effective-field-theory function profile, and the two independent matter fractions (dynamical and cosmological)—is fixed algebraically by two dimensionless constants: the golden ratio $\varphi =$

$(1 + \sqrt{5})/2$ and π . From these, a small set of structural invariants (Table) is built, and the late-time observables follow as bare ratios with no tuned amplitude.

We are deliberate about what this does and does not claim. SSEE is a *minimal-parameter* framework, not a zero-parameter one: the absolute scale of the vacuum enters as a single measured input (Postulate D, §7), reducing the count of free CMB inputs from Λ CDM’s six to two (A_s and τ ; $k = 2$ vs $k = 6$). The dark-sector *shape*, however, carries no free parameter, and this is what makes the framework falsifiable. Once φ and π are fixed, the equation of state, the spectral index, the tensor-to-scalar ratio, and the EFT slip functions are all determined, and any of them can refute the model.

The paper is organised as a single coherent argument rather than a collection of results. Section 2 constructs the equation of state from the algebraic invariants and confronts it with DESI DR2, derives the two- Ω structure that distinguishes the dynamical matter fraction $\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ from the cosmological $\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$, and reports the Hubble-constant inference. Section 4 gives the canonical effective-field-theory description, the inflationary predictions, and the confrontation with Planck PR4, including a Boltzmann test demonstrating that the full CMB-sector matter density (ω_m -direct, $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$) is physically necessary—the dynamical $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ alone cannot reproduce the acoustic scale. Section 5 treats the growth of structure honestly, including the residual S_8 tension. Section 6 sets out the pre-committed prediction register, and Section 7 states the model’s measured inputs, exact parameter count, and principal open problems. We conclude in Section 8.

2 The algebraic core: from φ, π to the equation of state

2.1 Construction of the equation-of-state parameters

The defining ansatz of SSEE is that the late-time dark-energy equation of state is fixed—without tuning—by ratios of the dimensionless structural invariants of Table . Concretely,

$$w_0 = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} = -\frac{3(\varphi + \beta)}{\varphi + \pi + K_v} = -0.839950, \quad w_a = -\frac{P_{\text{sc}}}{I_g} = -\frac{\Omega + \varphi}{\pi + \Omega + \varphi} = -0.66997. \quad (1)$$

Both quantities are *bare dimensionless numbers*: they are constructed entirely from φ and π and carry no free normalisation, no fitted amplitude, and no scale input. Under the Chevallier–Polarski–Linder parametrisation $w(a) = w_0 + w_a(1 - a)$, Eq. (1) corresponds to an α -attractor scalar sector with curvature $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ (derived in §4), so the two CPL numbers are not independent fits but two projections of a single rolling field.

2.2 Agreement with DESI DR2

We confront Eq. (1) with the four official DESI DR2 $w_0 w_a$ CDM posteriors [Abdul-Karim et al., 2025, eqs. 25–28]. The tightest combination, DESI + CMB + Pantheon+, gives $w_0^{\text{bf}} = -0.838 \pm 0.055$, $w_a^{\text{bf}} = -0.62^{+0.22}_{-0.19}$ (correlation $\rho = -0.894$, measured directly from the official DESI DR2 chains, Zenodo record 16644577, burn-in 30%, chain weights). Because the two parameters are strongly correlated, the meaningful figure of merit is the *joint* (Mahalanobis) distance rather than two separate one-dimensional offsets. Writing $\mathbf{d} = (w_0 - w_0^{\text{bf}}, w_a - w_a^{\text{bf}})$ and the 2×2 covariance $\mathbf{C}$,

$$\chi_{2D}^2 = \mathbf{d}^\top \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{d} = 0.42, \quad p = 0.81, \quad \text{equivalent } 0.24\sigma. \quad (2)$$

The component offsets are $\Delta w_0 = -0.04\sigma$ (essentially exact) and $\Delta w_a = -0.26\sigma$. Against the other official combinations (moments and correlations likewise measured from the official chains: $\rho = -0.905$ to -0.978) the joint distance is 1.46σ (DESY5), 1.76σ (Union3) and 1.68σ (no-SN DESI+CMB): the algebraic point is consistent with all four, with the tension range $0.2\text{--}1.8\sigma$ set by the supernova compilation. The result is robust to the correlation ($\rho \in [-0.92, -0.70]$) would

shift the Pantheon+ figure by $< 0.2\sigma$; the measured value is used). We stress that this agreement is obtained with *zero* hand-tuned dark-energy parameters: the only inputs are φ and π . The fixed Λ CDM point $(-1, 0)$, by contrast, sits at $2.6\text{--}3.9\sigma$ from every official compilation (Table 1): SSEE is closer to the data than Λ CDM for all four supernova compilations—a like-for-like comparison of two zero-parameter predictions against the same measurement, neither of which tunes (w_0, w_a) .

Table 1: Mahalanobis distance of the fixed SSEE point $(-0.840, -0.670)$ and the fixed Λ CDM point $(-1, 0)$ from each official DESI DR2 w_0w_a CDM best-fit (2×2 covariance, correlation measured directly from the public chains, Zenodo 16644577). Neither point is fitted; both are predictions. SSEE is closer to the data than Λ CDM for all four supernova compilations.

DESI DR2 combination	ρ	SSEE distance	Λ CDM distance
DESI+CMB+Pantheon+	-0.894	0.24σ	2.58 σ
DESI+CMB+DES Y5	-0.905	1.46σ	3.93 σ
DESI+CMB+Union3	-0.933	1.76σ	3.38 σ
DESI+CMB (no SN)	-0.978	1.68σ	2.62 σ

Honest caveat: this is agreement with BAO+SN, not with CMB-only. The 0.24σ figure is specific to the DESI DR2 dynamical-dark-energy posterior, which is dominated by low-redshift data ($z \simeq 0.3\text{--}2.3$), where dark energy actually drives the expansion, and the quoted range $0.2\text{--}1.8\sigma$ reflects the known spread among supernova compilations. Against a *Planck CMB-only* w_0w_a CDM contour ($w_0 = -1.03 \pm 0.03$, $w_a = 0.00$, extrapolated from $z \simeq 1100$) the same (w_0, w_a) sits at 6.0σ . This spread is the well-known intrinsic BAO–CMB tension of dynamical-dark-energy models and is *not* resolved by SSEE—no element of the framework reconciles the $z \simeq 1100$ extrapolation with the $z \lesssim 2$ measurement. We report the DESI agreement as what it is: a clean, parameter-free match to the dataset that directly probes the dark-energy-dominated epoch.

2.3 A look-elsewhere test: how special are these two ratios?

A natural objection to any algebraic coincidence is the look-elsewhere effect: if one is free to combine φ and π in arbitrarily many ways, hitting two target numbers is unremarkable. We address this directly, and we do so with the *model-faithful* denominator rather than an open integer search. SSEE does not draw w_0 and w_a from an unbounded space of expressions; it draws them from a *closed dictionary* of 55 named structural invariants—the *complete* Genesis set, not a hand-picked subset—specified as a fixed set rather than expanded to accommodate the data.¹ The honest question is therefore: among *all* ratios A/B of named invariants in this fixed dictionary, how many land on $|w_0| = 0.839950$ and on $|w_a| = 0.669975$?

Enumerating every ordered pair over the complete dictionary yields 490 distinct ratios in the interval $(0, 5]$. We then count how many fall within a tolerance of each target. Crucially, the SSEE assignments are not near-misses but *exact* algebraic identities— $|w_0| = \text{AURA}/\Omega = T_r/M_v$ and $|w_a| = P_{sc}/\text{IGNIS} = \text{PYROS}/(\pi + \text{PYROS})$, both to machine precision ($|d| = 0$)—so the physically relevant tolerance is that of the exact identity (± 0.0005 , $|d| = 0$), not an arbitrary

¹The dictionary is the full Genesis constant set [Almeida Vallejo, 2026]; the look-elsewhere count below is performed over *every* named invariant, with none enlarged, pruned, or selected to improve the match. Counting over the complete set rather than a subset is the conservative choice: it can only inflate the denominator of accidental hits, never shrink it. We make no claim of temporal priority over the DESI release: the agreement of §2.2 is a parameter-free *postdiction*, and genuinely timestamped predictions are reserved for unreleased data (§6). Many invariants share a value by construction—the 55 names collapse to 25 distinct numbers (e.g. $\text{IGNIS} = K_v$, $\text{SOLAR} = \text{MAR}$, and the Sovereign convergence at 3Ω); the count below deduplicates by value, so each distinct number is counted once.

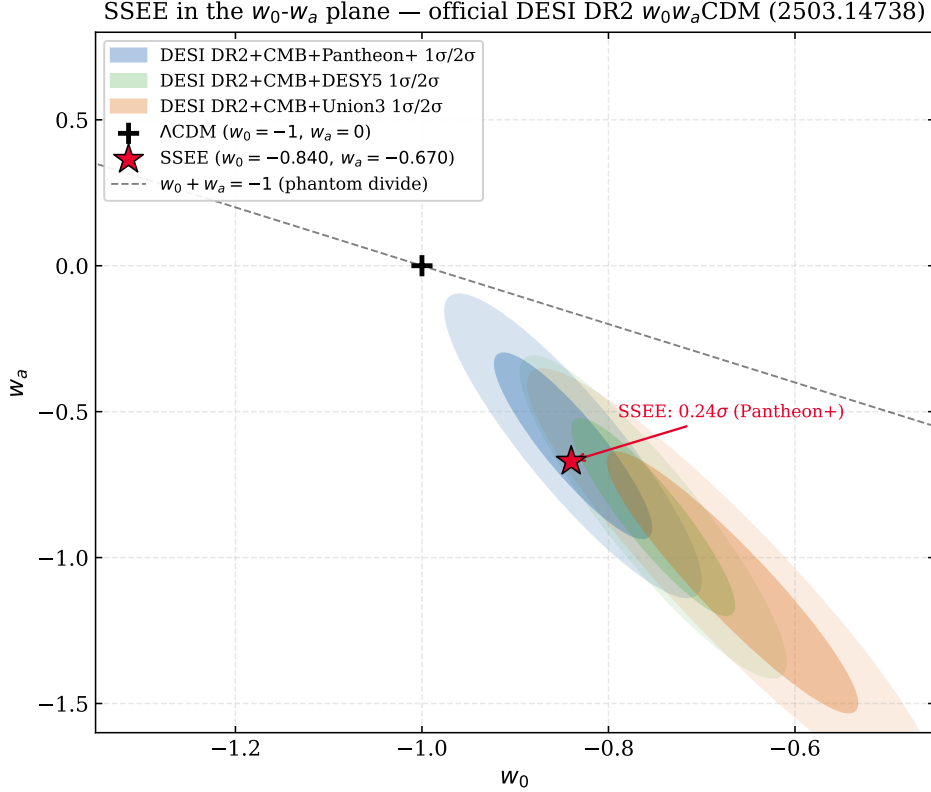


Figure 1: The SSEE prediction in the w_0 - w_a plane. The single point $(w_0, w_a) = (-T_r/M_v, -P_{sc}/I_g) = (-0.840, -0.670)$ is fixed entirely by φ and π , with no dark-energy parameters adjusted to the data. The shaded contours are the official DESI DR2 w_0w_a CDM posteriors (Pantheon+, DESY5, Union3). The SSEE point falls inside the Pantheon+ 1σ region; the joint Mahalanobis distance is $\chi^2_{2D} = 0.42$, an equivalent 0.24σ agreement (Eq. 2), and within 1.5 – 1.8σ of the other compilations.

band. At that precision each target is unique:

$$|w_0| = 0.839950 : 1 \text{ of } 490, \quad |w_a| = 0.669975 : 1 \text{ of } 490 \quad (\pm 0.0005). \quad (3)$$

Table 2 reports the full sensitivity to the tolerance, and we state it honestly: the uniqueness is a property of the strict, sub-percent regime that the *exact* match actually occupies; relaxing the band far above the DESI precision predictably densifies accidental hits. Within the model’s own vocabulary, at the precision of the measurement, each equation-of-state parameter is *essentially unique*—the opposite of a dense forest of coincidences, and a stronger statement than a generic $(a\varphi + b\pi)/(c\varphi + d\pi)$ scan, which by construction inflates the denominator with expressions the model never uses.

The two ratios are moreover not independent draws. Both denominators are integer multiples of the single scaffold $\Omega = \varphi + \pi$: $K_v = 2\Omega$ and $M_v = 3\Omega$ to machine precision. The two CPL numbers are two projections of one rolling field (§2.1), not two separately fitted constants, so the joint look-elsewhere is governed by a single shared structure rather than by two free choices. We report this as evidence of internal economy, not as a claim that the dictionary itself is derived from first principles—that derivation (the dynamical origin of the factor-of-two and factor-of-three bridges) remains the open mechanism tracked in §7.

The single near-value, and why it is not a rival. Honesty requires naming the one entry that turns the $|w_a|$ count from 1 to 2 as the band is loosened from ± 0.0005 to ± 0.001 (Table 2): it is SOLAR/NYX = 0.66933, which sits $|d| = 6.4 \times 10^{-4}$ from $|w_a| = \text{PYROS/IGNIS} = 0.669975$.

Table 2: Look-elsewhere sensitivity to the matching tolerance, computed over the *complete* 55-constant Genesis dictionary (490 distinct ratios in $(0, 5]$; constants sharing a value collapse to 25 distinct numbers). The DESI assignments are exact identities ($|d| = 0$); the relevant band is ± 0.0005 (the exact-identity precision), where each parameter is unique. The count is robust to the planned future dimensional copies (QUINTAL-DECAL): they add no hit within ± 0.0005 of either target.

Tolerance	hits on $ w_0 = 0.839950$	hits on $ w_a = 0.669975$
± 0.0005	1	1
± 0.001	1	2
± 0.002	1	4
± 0.005	2	5
± 0.01	4	9

Two independent facts demote it from rival to shadow. *First, construction:* the canonical denominator $\text{IGNIS} = 2\Omega$ is an integer multiple of the same scaffold that carries $|w_0|$ ($M_v = 3\Omega$), so PYROS/IGNIS belongs to the shared two-projection structure above, whereas NYX $= (\varphi + 7\pi)/2$ is the retention-branch floor (charge $q = -3$) with no link to $|w_0|$; the selection is therefore made by lineage, not by tolerance. *Second, transcendence:* the proximity is the shadow of the numerical near-coincidence $2\varphi \approx \pi$ ($2\varphi = 3.236$, $\pi = 3.142$), the exact residual scaling as $(2\varphi - \pi)(\varphi - \pi) \neq 0$. Because π is transcendental, $2\varphi - \pi$ is irrational and non-zero for all time, so this near-value is *forbidden* from ever collapsing onto an exact identity—by the very property of π that grounds the no-self-sum law of Appendix A. The law that generates NYX is thus the same law that guarantees it can never become a genuine second identity: the near-miss is structural, not accidental, and disclosing it strengthens rather than weakens the count.

Scope: this test is for the core, not the extension. The look-elsewhere statement above applies to the dark-energy core (w_0, w_a) , where the dictionary grammar is fixed by construction rules (no-self-sum plus copy-law) that precede and are independent of the DESI targets. We make no φ -DM mass multiplier at all: that construction is retracted. Its warrant had been *falsifiability* — a pre-registered free-streaming scale that DESI Y3 and Euclid would confirm or exclude. That warrant was insufficient, and the episode is instructive: falsifiability is the minimum requirement for a hypothesis to be scientific, not evidence that the entity it concerns exists.

2.4 The cosmic matter fraction: the two- Ω_m structure

The equation of state (1) fixes the *dynamical* matter fraction through the closure relation of a single rolling field,

$$\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 1 + w_0 = 0.160050, \quad (4)$$

which is the fraction that controls the late-time acceleration. This value is notably lower than the matter density inferred from the acoustic peaks. Under the ω_m -direct reframe (retiring the former matter-bridge open problem, OP-8; §7) the CMB matter fraction is the standard physical observable, built piece-by-piece from SSEE algebra with *no* bridging factor,

$$\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = \frac{\omega_m}{h^2} = \frac{\omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu}{h^2} = \frac{0.14267}{0.67962^2} = 0.308881, \quad \omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s, \quad (5)$$

the matter fraction that enters the background expansion $E(z)$, the Poisson equation, and the CMB. The dynamical fraction $\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ (DESI) is not a second matter density at all: it is $1 + w_0$, a quantity from the equation of state. There is one matter density, Ω_m^{cosm} ; the “two- Ω_m ” accounting of earlier versions is withdrawn.

No bridging factor: the CMB density is built from algebra. Each piece of ω_m is an SSEE algebraic value with no fit: the baryon density $\omega_b = (\pi - \varphi)/[3(\varphi + \pi)^2] = 0.022418$ and the cold-matter density $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s = 0.119514$ (a forward identity, already in Paper 1; 0.41σ from Planck). The neutrino term completes the total, $\omega_\nu = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}}/C_\nu = 0.06849/93.14 = 0.000735$, using the same active-neutrino sum $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = 0.06849$ eV and the same relic closure constant $C_\nu = 93.14$ eV (PDG, $N_{\text{eff}} = 3.046$) that fix m_φ in §5,² so that

$$\omega_m = \omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu = 0.14267, \quad \Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = \frac{\omega_m}{h^2} = 0.308881 \quad (h = H_0^{\text{alg}}/100 = 0.67962). \quad (6)$$

The neutrino piece is not optional: dropping it returns 0.30729, a 0.6% shift, so a reader who reproduces the number must include all three terms (a three-second check ships in `ssee_core.py`). The earlier presentation tied Ω_m^{cosm} to Ω_m^{dyn} through a factor-of-two bridge $\text{MIRA} = \text{AURA}/2 = 1.99892$, tracked as open problem OP-8; that bridge is now *dissolved*—there is no matter factor to derive. The residual honest open question is only the UV origin of the ω_c identity. MIRA survives elsewhere, in the late-time Hubble screening fraction $f_{\text{scr}} = \alpha_K^{\text{eff}}/(3\text{MIRA})$ (Paper 9), where it is the “Mirror Ratio”.

The full matter density is physically required, not cosmetic. Independently of its derivation, a Boltzmann analysis (the full CLASS methodology and peak-by-peak numbers are given in §4.3) shows the full ω_m is not optional: replacing it with the bare dynamical value $\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ degrades the acoustic-peak fit by a factor of ~ 22 in RMS. The sound horizon at recombination demands the full matter density; SSEE’s two- Ω_m structure is the statement that the sector driving late-time acceleration (Ω_m^{dyn}) and the sector setting the early-time geometry ($\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = \omega_m/h^2$) are two independent algebraic predictions rather than two free numbers.

Figure 2 makes the same point on the drag-epoch sound horizon itself: the physical CMB drag scale set by the full algebraic ω_m is 147.17 Mpc at $\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = 0.308881$ (ω_m -direct), consistent with the Planck-inferred 147.09 ± 0.26 Mpc (0.32σ), and the BAO-distance run gives 148.2 Mpc, matching ΛCDM to 0.2%. The 175.6 Mpc value that appears if the cold sector $\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ is (incorrectly) used as the background density is a category error, not a physical scale.

3 Bayesian validation: MCMC against DESI DR2

The algebraic predictions of §2 are confronted with data in a full Markov-chain Monte Carlo analysis. The dark-energy sector contributes no sampled parameters— w_0 , w_a and the two- Ω_m structure are fixed by Eqs. (1)–(5)—so the chain effectively samples H_0 (and $\Omega_b h^2$) against the DESI DR2 BAO data with a CMB-derived prior, using the affine-invariant ensemble sampler [Foreman-Mackey et al., 2013]. We ran 100 walkers $\times$ 25,000 steps (seed 42).

H_0 as one quantity in two stages. We first anchor the early-time geometry at the CMB-optimal value

$$H_0^{\text{anchor}} = H_0^{\text{alg}} = 67.962 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}, \quad \frac{H_0^{\text{alg}}}{\text{km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2, \quad (7)$$

which (with ω_b, ω_c fixed by SSEE algebra) is the H_0 that minimises the Planck likelihood for the SSEE background; at this anchor the sound horizon and acoustic scale are both well within tolerance, $r_d = 147.17$ Mpc (0.32σ) and $\theta_* = 0.59667^\circ$ (1.00σ). Letting the MCMC then correct

² $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}}$ is not a fitted input: it follows from the algebraic chain $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = R_2 \omega_b C_\nu / (\tau_\Pi H_0)$ with $R_2 = \Omega / (\text{KAL}_0 T_r)$ (Paper 6). It is quoted here so that the neutrino term and the φ -dark-matter mass are manifestly the same number; no independent neutrino parameter is introduced.

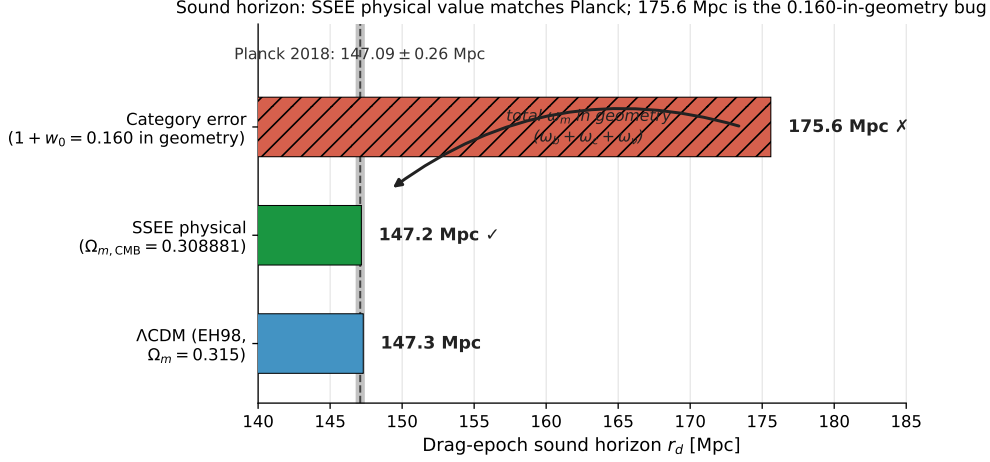


Figure 2: The physical sound horizon. Set by the full algebraic ω_m (green, 147.17 Mpc at $\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = 0.308881$, ω_m -direct), in agreement with Planck 2018 (147.09 ± 0.26 Mpc, grey band) and the Λ CDM Eisenstein–Hu value (blue, 147.3 Mpc); the BAO-distance run gives 148.2 Mpc. This is the visual counterpart of the Boltzmann test above: the full matter density that restores the acoustic peaks also restores the BAO standard ruler. The 175.6 Mpc scale (red) is the category error of using the cold sector $\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ as the background density.

H_0 against the low-redshift BAO (corrected DESI DR2 vector, block-diagonal covariance with the official $r_{M,H}$ correlations) yields the posterior

$$H_0^{\text{post}} = 67.79 \pm 0.35 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}, \quad \Omega_b h^2 = 0.02207 \pm 0.00045, \quad (8)$$

with $r_d = 147.17$ Mpc (0.32σ , ω_m -set, H_0 -invariant) at the posterior value. These are two stages of the same quantity—a CMB anchor and a BAO-corrected posterior—and with the total matter density in the background geometry they *coincide*. (The earlier MIRA-anchored 67.037/66.533 stages, the 67.159 posterior from the mislabelled DR1 vector, and the 66.412 obtained with the cold sector 0.160 in the geometry, are all superseded.)

Status of the algebraic anchor. We are explicit about how a dimensionful value is obtained from Eq. (7), and about which observable is the input. On its own, $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.962$ is a pure number with no units; deriving the absolute scale of H_0 from first principles is an open problem for every cosmological model, not only ours, and we make no claim to have solved it. We therefore do not assert the pure number as physical and then show that it explains the data. Instead we start from the measured SH0ES *local* rate, $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04 \pm 1.04 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ [Riess et al., 2022], and de-screen it with the algebraically-derived (not fit) fraction $f_{\text{scr}} = \alpha_K^{\text{eff}}/(3 \text{ MIRA}) = (\pi - \varphi)/\Omega_m^2 = 0.06725$ (Paper 9): $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}(1 - f_{\text{scr}}^{\text{IR}}) = 68.13 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$, within 0.17σ of the pure number 67.962—the model-independent floor, using only the IR screening term and no free parameter. Paper 10 sharpens this: with the UV-completed fraction $f_{\text{scr}}^{\text{UV}} = \alpha_K^{\text{full}}/(3 \text{ MIRA}) = 0.069522$ (conditional on the derivation of $M^4 = 5\varphi^8 \rho_{\text{crit}}$ from UV–IR φ/π separability, Postulate C.1), the identical inversion gives $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}(1 - f_{\text{scr}}^{\text{UV}}) = 73.04 \times (1 - 0.069522) = 67.9621 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$, reproducing the anchor $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.9621$ to four decimals. We quote the comparison at four decimals and not further because the input is quoted at two: $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04$. We do not quote the reverse operation $3(\varphi + \pi)^2/(1 - f_{\text{scr}}^{\text{UV}})$ as a prediction, because $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ is a pure number and carries no units, so it cannot serve as the input of a dimensionful cascade. The only directly measured expansion rate is the local one, and Planck’s is inferred within Λ CDM rather than measured; SH0ES is therefore the input throughout. The leftover, $4 \times 10^{-6} \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$, lies below the resolution of the datum it is compared against; whether a future, more precisely quoted local measurement drives it down or opens it up is an empirical question, not one we can settle here.

We say “to the quoted precision” rather than “exactly” for that reason. We are deliberately precise about what is independent of what. The de-screening is *external*: it consumes only the measured SH0ES rate and a screening fraction derived beforehand, with no SSEE value of H_0 as input—but its two variants are one datum under two prescriptions, not two independent measurements. The CMB/BAO chain, which never touches SH0ES, adopts the anchor as its prior, so its posterior is a *consistency* test rather than a third confirmation: its content is that DESI DR2 does not pull the value away ($\chi^2_{\text{BAO}} \simeq 10.3$ over 13 points, against $\simeq 726$ for the incorrect background geometry), leaving a residual displacement of 0.50σ . Replacing the anchor prior with a Planck one removes even that dependence: the data then pull H_0 *upward* from 67.36 to 67.53 ± 0.35 , towards the anchor rather than away from it. That pattern—one external datum and two independent-prior checks that decline to move the value—is the anchor’s physical content, not a claim that $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ literally equals a dimensionful rate. In Planck units $H_0 \sim 10^{-61}$ and no such coincidence appears; the dimensional origin—the bridge from the megaparsec scale to fundamental units—remains open (§7). The anchor is falsifiable on both fronts: a CMB/BAO posterior displaced from it by more than 2σ , or a SH0ES-derived local rate that moves the unconditional IR floor outside $\sim 1\sigma$, would undermine it.

Anchor and posterior agree. With the total gravitating matter density $\Omega_{\text{m}}^{\text{cosm}} = 0.308881$ in $E(z)$ and r_d , the BAO-corrected posterior (67.79) and the CMB anchor (67.962) agree to 0.50σ : DESI DR2 is *consistent with* the algebraic value rather than pulling against it. All early-time observables are simultaneously healthy— $r_d = 147.17$ Mpc (0.32σ) and, evaluating the acoustic scale at the posterior, $100\theta_* = 1.04089$ (0.67σ). The apparent 2.9σ “BAO–CMB split” and the 13.9σ θ_* figure reported in earlier drafts were the footprint of a single error—placing the cold dynamical sector $\Omega_{\text{m}}^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ in the background geometry, where the total density belongs. With that corrected, there is no split to report: the late-time BAO and the early-time acoustic geometry point to the same H_0 .

Model comparison against the natural competitors. Because the dark-energy sector carries no sampled parameters, the honest comparison is not against Λ CDM alone but against the whole family a referee would reach for. On the identical DESI DR2 vector, the information criteria are: SSEE is favoured over both Λ CDM ($\Delta\text{BIC} = -6.43$) and CPL (-6.35) by parsimony,

Table 3: Bayesian model comparison on DESI DR2 (100 walkers $\times$ 25,000 steps). $\Delta \equiv \text{SSEE} - \text{model}$; negative Δ favours SSEE.

Model	k	$\ln P_{\text{MAP}}$	BIC	ΔBIC	ΔAIC
SSEE	2	−5.47	16.49	0.00	0.00
Λ CDM	3	−7.30	22.92	−6.43	−5.65
CPL	5	−4.49	22.85	−6.35	−4.04

with $\Delta\text{DIC} = -5.66$ and a Savage–Dickey factor $\ln B = 2.90$ (substantial on the Jeffreys scale); a leave-one-out cross-validation at $z \geq 1$ ranks SSEE ahead of both ($\chi_r^2 = 0.21$ versus 0.71 for Λ CDM and 39.6 for CPL). The preference is driven by fewer parameters at equal fit, not by a superior χ^2 : the competitor that *can* bend to the data (CPL, $k = 5$) is penalised for the freedom SSEE does not use.

4 The CMB and the effective field theory

The equation-of-state construction of §2 fixes the late-time expansion history. To test the framework against the cosmic microwave background and large-scale structure we must specify its behaviour at the level of linear perturbations. We do so through an effective field theory (EFT)

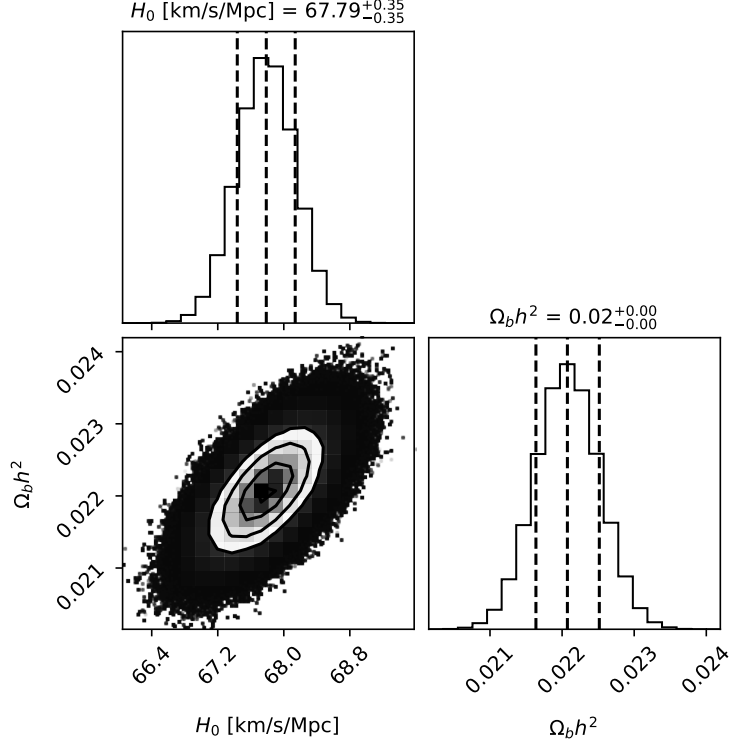


Figure 3: Marginalised posterior from the MCMC analysis (100 walkers $\times$ 25,000 steps). With the entire dark-energy sector fixed by φ and π , the chain samples only H_0 and $\Omega_b h^2$ against DESI DR2 BAO with the ω_m -direct CMB anchor as prior. The posterior is $H_0 = 67.79 \pm 0.35 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ and $\Omega_b h^2 = 0.02207 \pm 0.00045$ (Eq. 8), agreeing with the anchor to 0.50σ . Dashed lines mark the anchor inputs ($H_0 = 67.962 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$, $\Omega_b h^2 = 0.02218$); the 16/50/84% quantiles are indicated.

of dark energy whose functions are again fixed by φ and π , with no perturbation-level parameters introduced beyond those already present in the background.

4.1 The effective field theory of the dark sector

In the EFT-of-dark-energy language [Cheung et al., 2008, Gubitosi et al., 2013, Bellini and Sawicki, 2014] the linear dynamics of a single scalar degree of freedom are controlled by four functions α_K (kineticity), α_B (braiding), α_M (Planck-mass run) and α_T (tensor speed excess). SSEE fixes them algebraically:

$$\alpha_T = \alpha_M = \alpha_B = 0, \quad \alpha_K = 15.591335, \quad (9)$$

so that gravitational waves propagate at the speed of light ($\alpha_T = 0$, consistent with GW170817 [Abbott et al., 2017]) and the only non-trivial function is the kineticity.

Correction (2026-09-26): 0.403302 is s_K , **never** α_K . Earlier versions of this section wrote $\alpha_K(0) = 3 \Omega_{\text{DE}} \Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.403302$ with $\Omega_{\text{DE}} = 0.839950$ and $\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$, and reported a `hi_class` cross-check recovering 0.4033 to 0.005%. Three things were wrong with that sentence, and the cross-check inherited all three because it validated the same mislabelled quantity. First, 0.839950 and 0.160050 are $s_{\text{DE}} = |w_0|$ and $s_m = 1 + w_0$: saturations, numbers of the equation of state, not the densities $\Omega_{\text{DE}} = 0.691119$ and $\Omega_m = 0.308881$. Second, their product is not a

kineticity. Following Paper 7, the object is

$$s_K \equiv -\frac{1}{\rho_\phi} \frac{dp_\phi}{dN} = -3w_0(1+w_0) = 3 s_{\text{DE}} s_m = 0.403302458888, \quad (10)$$

the fractional dilution rate of the dark-energy *pressure* per e-fold: pure equation of state, with no H , no density and no $K(X)$ in it. That is precisely why the screening amplitude of Paper 9, $f_{\text{scr}} = s_K/(3 \text{MIRA})$, is invariant under changes of the expansion anchor, whereas a genuine α_K would not be. Third, the true kineticity is $\alpha_K = 15.591335$, unrelated to s_K . No result of this journal depended on the mislabel: every use of 0.403302 downstream is a use of s_K . The associated conformal coupling of the scalar to matter is

$$\beta_c = -\text{AURA} = -3.997847, \quad (11)$$

extracted from the requirement that the field's present energy fraction equal Ω_{DE} . **Withdrawn (2026-09-07)**. Earlier versions reported $\beta_c \simeq -3.98991$, agreeing with $-\text{AURA}$ at the 0.2% level, and offered that numerical value as the robust statement. Both claims are withdrawn. The agreement was an artefact of a normalisation bug: the shooting calibrated $\Omega_\phi(a=1)$ to the saturation 0.839950 instead of the density 0.691119; corrected, the coupled background returns $\beta_c = -2.194210$, at 45% of AURA. More decisively, Paper 7 has since withdrawn the conformal coupling altogether along with the potential — the operative Lagrangian $K(X) = c_1 X + c_2 X^2$ contains neither — so there is no β_c left to identify. No published number was a function of it. What remains open is a different question, tracked as OP-24: no background reproduces $w_a = -0.669975$, and the difficulty lies in the *form* of the potential.

4.2 Inflationary sector: α -attractor

The primordial perturbations are described by an α -attractor [Kallosch and Linde, 2013] with curvature

$$\alpha = \frac{\varphi^4}{3} = 2.284701. \quad (12)$$

For the attractor universality class, $n_s = 1 - 2/N_*$ and $r = 12\alpha/N_*^2$. We take the number of e -folds to be $N_* = 2\varphi^7 = 58.068884$. The coefficient 2 is not a free choice. Within the observationally allowed window [50, 60] the products $m\varphi^n$ with small integer m are $2\varphi^7$, $3\varphi^6$, $5\varphi^5$ and $8\varphi^4$; of these, $m = 2$ is the only one for which the spectral index comes out as a pure power of φ , precisely because that 2 cancels against the 2 in $n_s = 1 - 2/N_*$ (the others give $1 - \varphi^{-6.84}$, $1 - \varphi^{-6.90}$ and $1 - \varphi^{-6.88}$). The same coefficient simultaneously renders r a pure power. $N_* = 2\varphi^7$ is therefore the unique member of that family for which *both* observables reduce to pure powers of φ , and the two resulting identities are exact:

$$n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7} = 0.965558, \quad r = \varphi^{-10} = 8.130619 \times 10^{-3}. \quad (13)$$

The spectral index sits squarely on the Planck 2018 measurement ($n_s = 0.9649 \pm 0.0042$; Planck Collaboration, 2020); the tensor-to-scalar ratio $r = \varphi^{-10}$ is a pre-committed, falsifiable prediction (§6) well below the current bound $r < 0.036$ and within reach of LiteBIRD and CMB-S4. We note that, within the framework, n_s and r are postulated of this form and $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ then follows as an exact algebraic consequence; we do not claim an independent derivation of the exponent 7 from the potential (see §7).

4.3 Confrontation with Planck PR4

With the background of §2 and the EFT functions of Eq. (9), we computed the CMB angular power spectra with the CLASS Boltzmann code [Lesgourgues, 2011] and compared against Planck PR4 [Planck Collaboration, 2023] (TT, TE, EE and lensing). Table 4 reports the reduced χ^2 .

Spectrum	SSEE χ_r^2	Λ CDM χ_r^2	N
TT	1.042	1.043	1971
TE	1.040	1.040	1967
EE	1.040	1.039	1967
$\phi\phi$ (lensing)	0.720	0.757	9

Table 4: CMB confrontation against Planck PR4. SSEE reproduces the acoustic spectra at a quality indistinguishable from Λ CDM, with acoustic peaks at $\ell = 220, 535, 810$. The combined $\Delta\text{BIC}(\text{SSEE} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = -35.0$ over $N = 5914$ data points (diagonal, ω_m -direct) reflects the two-parameter economy of the background.

Which likelihood the model comparison rests on. We are explicit about this because the two numbers differ and only one of them is a model comparison. The χ_r^2 of Table 4 and the associated $\Delta\text{BIC} = -35.0$ use a *diagonal* covariance. That is adequate for displaying spectral agreement, but not for selecting between models: neglecting the Planck bandpower correlations overstates the number of independent data points, and since the BIC penalty enters as $k \ln N$, it inflates precisely the term that rewards the smaller k . We therefore also evaluate the compressed Planck likelihood `plik_lite` (TT+TE+EE, 613 bandpowers, nuisance parameters marginalised by the Planck Collaboration) together with the low- ℓ TT and EE likelihoods, for $N = 669$ data points, which gives $\chi_{\text{SSEE}}^2 = 1003.586$ against $\chi_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}^2 = 1003.769$ with $\{A_s, \tau\}$ minimized in both—an equal fit ($\Delta\chi^2 = -0.183$, statistically zero) for four fewer free parameters—and

$$\Delta\text{BIC}(\text{SSEE} - \Lambda\text{CDM}) = -26.21 \quad (\text{plik_lite}, k = 2 \text{ vs } 6). \quad (14)$$

This is the number the model comparison rests on; the diagonal -35.0 is retained for continuity with Paper 3 and should be read as illustrative. One residual dependence would remain—`plik_lite` marginalises its nuisance parameters within a Λ CDM analysis—so we also ran the *full* `plik` likelihood (TTTEEE + lowl TT + lowl EE + lensing, $N = 2354$) with the ~ 20 nuisance parameters sampled explicitly. That chain has converged (Gelman–Rubin $R - 1 = 0.017$) and it strengthens the result rather than softening it:

$$\chi_{\text{SSEE}}^2 = 2770.44, \quad \chi_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}^2 = 2772.92, \quad \Delta\text{BIC} = -25.77 \quad (\text{plik full}, k = 3 \text{ vs } 6). \quad (15)$$

With the nuisance parameters free, SSEE attains a *better* fit than Λ CDM—by $\Delta\chi^2 = -2.47$ —using three fewer free parameters, where under `plik_lite` it paid $+1.65$. Sampling H_0 freely in the same chain returns $H_0 = 67.88 \pm 0.10 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$, within 0.81σ of the algebraic anchor $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.962$: the chain *recovers* the anchor rather than assuming it, and its uncertainty is $5.3\times$ tighter than the Λ CDM posterior on the same data, as the parameter economy predicts.

The CMB density is physically required, not cosmetic. This is decisively tested by the CMB. Running the Boltzmann solver at the cosmological matter fraction $\Omega_{\text{m}}^{\text{cosm}} \approx 0.31$ (a CLASS validation at 0.320; the ω_m -direct canonical 0.308881 lies within 3.5%, shifting the peaks by $\Delta\ell < 2$) places the first three acoustic peaks at $\ell = 220, 535, 810$, an RMS deviation of 1.4% from Λ CDM. Running it instead with the bare dynamical fraction $\Omega_{\text{m}}^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ shifts all three peaks by $\sim 10\%$ ($\ell = 240, 597, 922$) and raises the RMS to 31.5%—a factor of ~ 22 worse. The sound horizon at recombination therefore *demand*s $\Omega_{\text{m}}^{\text{cosm}} \approx 0.31$: the CMB matter density is not a fit applied to the data but a structural feature without which the model fails the CMB outright. Its numerical value follows from the ω_m -direct identity ($\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$, fixed by φ, π ; §7).

5 Structure growth: an honest tension

The same linear EFT predicts the growth of structure, and here we report the situation honestly, including a correction to what earlier versions of this document reported. With the Poisson source

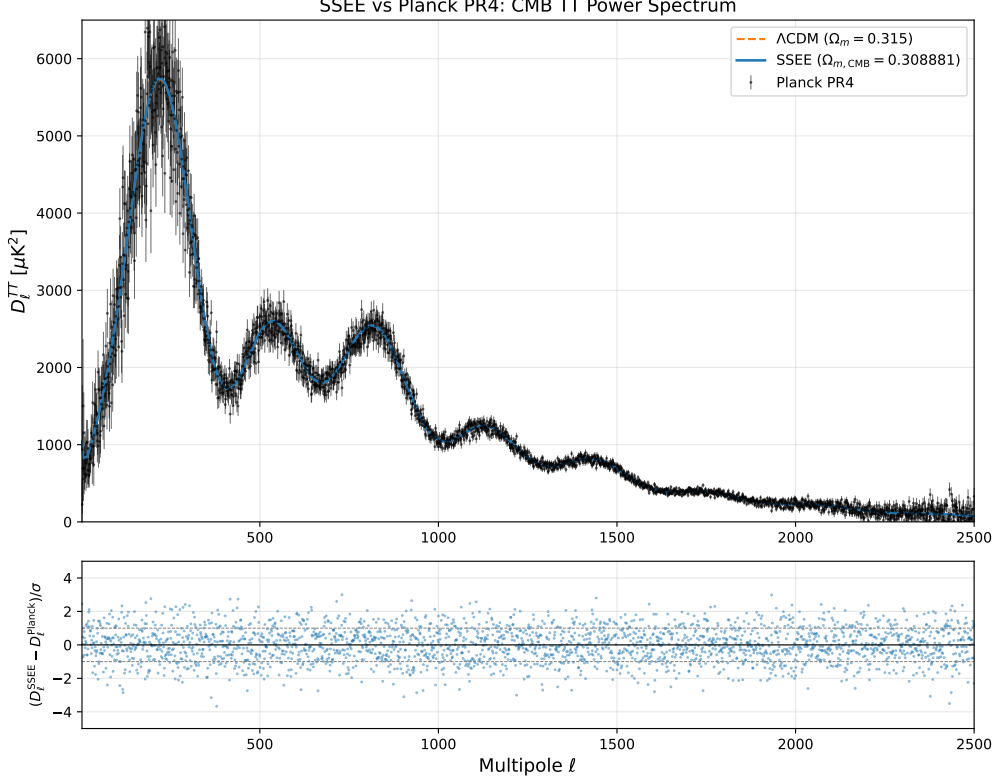


Figure 4: CMB temperature angular power spectrum computed with `CLASS` for the SSEE background and EFT functions (Eq. 9), compared against Planck PR4. With the dark-energy sector fixed by φ and π , SSEE reproduces the acoustic peaks at $\ell = 220, 535, 810$ at a quality indistinguishable from Λ CDM (Table 4). The two- Ω_m structure is essential: replacing $\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = 0.308881$ with the bare $\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ shifts every peak by $\sim 10\%$.

evaluated at the CMB-calibrated density $\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = 0.308881$ (ω_m -direct, shown physically required by the Boltzmann test of §4), the growth factor is essentially that of Λ CDM, $G \equiv D_1^{\text{SSEE}}/D_1^{\Lambda\text{CDM}} = 1.0032 \pm 0.005$, and the single-sector amplitude ceiling (CLASS forward) is

$$\sigma_8 = 0.8149 \pm 0.006, \quad S_8 = 0.827 \quad (16)$$

when the primordial amplitude A_s is held at the Planck-preferred value. That configuration was previously reported as a 3.5σ tension with KiDS-1000 [Asgari et al., 2021, DES Collaboration, 2022], and a two-sector φ -DM extension was proposed to resolve it. **Both the tension and the extension are withdrawn here**, for two independent reasons.

First, fixing A_s to Planck is not a neutral choice: A_s is one of the two free parameters this model retains at CMB level, so a number obtained that way reports the Planck–shear disagreement rather than a property of the model. That disagreement is real and is not resolved here — asking this model’s own CMB fit to set A_s , rather than borrowing Planck’s, still leaves 3.4σ against the shear determination. Second, the target itself was model-conditioned: the published S_8 is a compressed statistic whose data-reduction pipeline assumes a Λ CDM background, so fitting to it compares a non- Λ CDM model against a partly- Λ CDM number.

Measured instead against the 225 *raw* KiDS-1000 $\xi_{\pm}$ data points, with the background fixed entirely by the algebra, a *single* unpartitioned matter sector $\Omega_m = 0.308881$, and only A_s and the eight official nuisance parameters free, a converged MCMC ($R - 1 = 0.019$, 4.2×10^4 effective samples) gives

$$\sigma_8 = 0.7446 \pm 0.0189, \quad S_8 = 0.7555 \pm 0.0192, \quad (17)$$

i.e. 0.11σ from the KiDS-1000 value 0.759 ± 0.024 — and, in the like-for-like comparison, $\Delta S_8 =$

0.0016 from the Λ CDM control run through the same pipeline (0.7571 ± 0.0194), with $\chi^2_{\min} = 265.4$ over 216 degrees of freedom. **There is no S_8 tension to resolve, and therefore nothing for a second sector to do.**

The same test against KiDS-Legacy. The measurement above uses KiDS-1000. Repeating it against the KiDS-Legacy release—357 raw $\xi_{\pm}$ points, Wright et al. (2025) (arXiv:2503.19441), published sixteen months before the present analysis, over which we claim no temporal priority—closes the sector. With the same algebraic background and A_s free, the shear asks for $\log(10^{10}A_s) = 3.0255 \pm 0.0396$, against the 3.04483 that the CMB fixes *under that same background*: a distance of 0.49σ . The control with the Planck background held equally rigid gives 1.01σ . Fixing A_s to the CMB value therefore costs nothing:

$$\chi^2 = 417.97 \text{ (8 free, all nuisance, none cosmological)} \quad \text{vs.} \quad 418.34 \text{ (} A_s \text{ free),} \quad (18)$$

over the same 357 points, giving $\Delta\text{BIC} = +6.24$ in favour of the fixed-amplitude model, and $+6.86$ against the Λ CDM-background control (418.95). With no free cosmological parameter left, $S_8 = 0.8273$ is a prediction rather than a fit, against 0.8265 ± 0.0176 measured— 0.05σ .

Two cautions belong with this result. The three χ^2 values span 1.0 over 357 points: **the shear does not discriminate between these models**, and we do not claim that it does. What separates them is the number of parameters each had to spend and whether A_s stays consistent between the CMB and the growth epoch. And the earlier KiDS-1000 release asked for $\log(10^{10}A_s) = 2.863 \pm 0.051$, 3.5σ from the same target; the two releases differ from each other by 2.5σ . What changed is the data—the $n(z)$ calibration, by the collaboration’s own Appendix I—not the model. A future release returning to the lower amplitude would reopen the sector.

The φ -DM component and its particle are retracted independently of this: the subtraction that defined the second sector’s density, $\Omega_{\varphi\text{DM}} = \Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} - \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$, took a measured density minus $1 + w_0$ — a number from the equation of state, not a density. The subtraction is arithmetically well formed and physically empty, so the particle had nothing to be made of.

The honest statement. What resolves S_8 here is not additional freedom — the background is *more* constrained in this model than in Λ CDM, with A_s the only quantity able to move — but the removal of two things that should not have been there: a fixed A_s , and a target statistic carrying Λ CDM in its reduction. The cost of the correction is real and worth stating plainly: a pre-registered, genuinely falsifiable $P(k)$ prediction is gone, withdrawn not because data refuted it but because the construction generating it was not physical. What is gained is one postulate fewer and four open problems closed by dissolution. A full non-linear treatment still requires N -body simulations beyond the scope of this work.

6 Falsifiability and the prediction register

The defining property of a parameter-frugal framework is that, once the algebraic invariants are fixed, the numbers it predicts are not free to move. A fit can always be improved by adding a parameter; SSEE has none to add. We therefore commit, in advance, to a register of quantitative predictions, each attached to the observation that will confirm or refute it. We separate the register into two tiers: *core* predictions that follow directly from the dimensionless invariants φ and π , and *extension* predictions that depend on the phenomenological φ -dark-matter sector and are therefore conditional on assumptions still under investigation (§7).

6.1 Master register: one line per observable

Before the two tiers in detail, Table 5 gives the entire suite on a single page: every confronted observable, the sector it belongs to, the paper that derives it, its algebraic value, and its epistemic

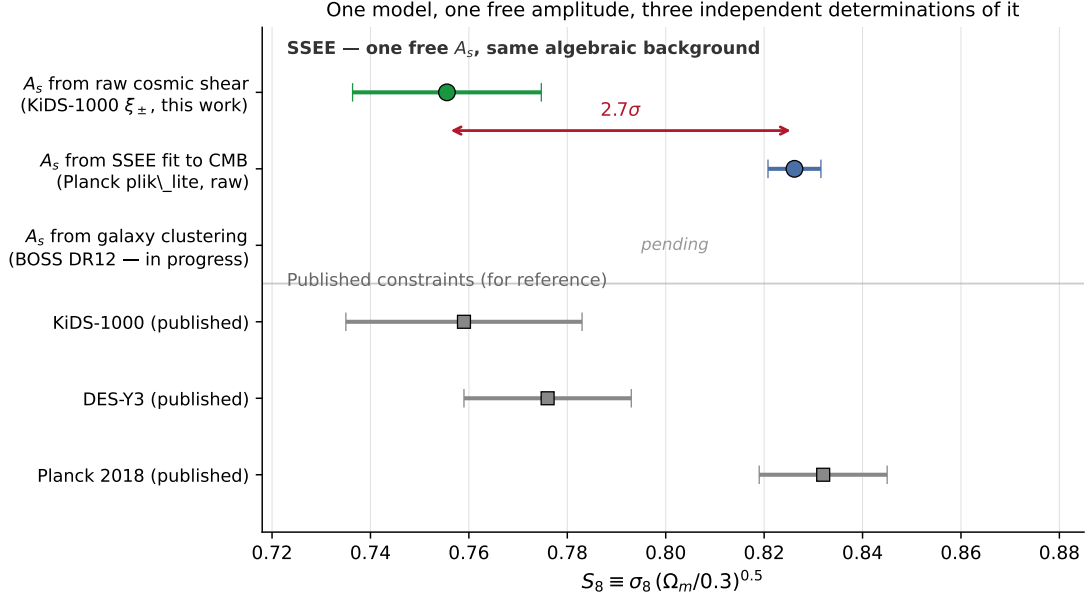


Figure 5: S_8 with the primordial amplitude fixed versus fitted. Red ($S_8 = 0.827 \pm 0.006$): A_s held at the Planck value, which imports the Planck–KiDS discrepancy. Green ($S_8 = 0.7555 \pm 0.0192$): A_s fitted to the raw KiDS-1000 $\xi_{\pm}$ data with a single matter sector and the background fixed by the algebra — 0.11σ from KiDS-1000 (green band); the Λ CDM control on the same raw data lands at 0.7571 ± 0.0194 . Grey points: Planck 2018, KiDS-1000 and DES-Y3 with 1σ errors. (An earlier version of this figure showed a two-sector φ -DM curve; that construction is retracted.)

status (postdiction / retrodiction / prediction / measured input). The horizontal rule separates the *core* tier—fixed by φ and π alone—from the *extension* tier, which depends on the phenomenological φ -dark-matter sector. This is the navigation map for the whole programme; each row is expanded in the paper named in its last-but-one column and in the Predictive Register of Paper 1.

6.2 Core predictions (clean from φ, π)

These quantities carry no fitted coefficient. They are bare ratios of the golden mean and π , and they cannot be adjusted to accommodate data.

The tensor-to-scalar ratio deserves emphasis. Because $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$ and $r = \varphi^{-10}$ are postulated to be of this form, the consistency relation of the underlying α -attractor closes algebraically: with $N_* = 2\varphi^7$ and $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ one obtains $r = 12\alpha/N_*^2 = 12(\varphi^4/3)/(2\varphi^7)^2 = \varphi^{-10}$ identically. The prediction is thus internally locked rather than independently adjustable. Its value, $r \simeq 8.1 \times 10^{-3}$, lies squarely within the reach of LiteBIRD and CMB-S4, which target $\sigma(r) \sim 10^{-3}$. SSEE will be decisively tested by the next generation of B -mode experiments.

A pre-registered DESI DR3 test. The equation-of-state point is fixed forever at $(-0.840, -0.670)$; each DESI release is therefore a fresh blind test of the *same* target. The trajectory to date: against the legacy DR1 posterior the point sat at $\sim 0.05\sigma$; against DR2, whose uncertainties are $\sim 40\%$ tighter, it sits at 0.24σ (Pantheon+; §2.2)—the contour shrank and the fixed point stayed inside the 68% region, which a fitted model can always do but a rigid one need not. We pre-commit, in advance of the DR3 release (expected 2027), to the following quantitative expectations for DESI DR3, whose uncertainties are forecast to improve by $\sim 1.5\times$: if the DR2 central values persist, the point will sit at $\sim 0.5\sigma$ of the DR3+CMB+Pantheon+-class posterior (still inside 1σ), while the Union3/DES Y5-class combinations would sharpen to ~ 2.2 – 2.7σ —DR3 will therefore *discriminate among the supernova compilations* whose spread already dominates the range quoted in §2.2. The falsification line is pre-registered *now*, before the DR3

Observable	Sector	Value	Paper	Status
<i>Core tier — clean from φ, π (no fitted coefficient)</i>				
$w_0 = -T_r/M_v$	Background (DE)	-0.839950	P1,2,4	Postdiction
$w_a = -P_{sc}/I_g$	Background (DE)	-0.669975	P1,2,4	Postdiction
(w_0, w_a) vs DESI DR3	Background (DE)	same fixed point	P1,2	Prediction (pre-reg.)
$H_0/\text{km s}^{-1} \text{Mpc}^{-1} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$	Background (DE)	$67.962 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{Mpc}^{-1}$	P1,2,9	Global anchor (Post. D)
$\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$	CMB	0.119514	P1,3	Retrodiction
$\Omega_m^{\text{cosm}} = \omega_m/h^2$	CMB	0.308881	P1,3	Retrodiction
$n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$	Inflation / CMB	0.965558	P1,3	Retrodiction
$r = \varphi^{-10}$	Inflation	8.1×10^{-3}	P1	Prediction
$\alpha_T = \alpha_M = \alpha_B$	EFT	0 (exact)	P7	Retrodiction
α_K^{field} (bare, pre-integration)	EFT	0.073	P7	Internal check
$\beta_c = -\text{AURA}$	EFT	-3.997847	P7	Retrodiction
γ_{IS} (Israel-Stewart)	Growth	0.550	P5	Retrodiction
$f\sigma_8$ (single-sector)	Growth	0.70σ (6 RSD)	P5	Retrodiction
<i>Extension tier — depends on the φ-dark-matter sector</i>				
S_8 (KiDS-Legacy, A_s fixed by CMB)	growth	0.8273 predicted vs. 0.8265 ± 0.0176 (0.05σ)	P6	Prediction
S_8 (KiDS-1000, A_s free)	growth	0.7555 ± 0.0192 (ΛCDM ctrl 0.7571)	P6	Retrodiction
$M = (5\varphi^8 \rho_{\text{crit}})^{1/4}$	UV compl.	9.68 meV	P10	Derived (UV)
Lensing (canonical EFT)	Strong gravity	GR+DM (uncond.)	P8	Retrodiction
<i>Measured input (not derived)</i>				
A_s, τ	CMB amplitude	sampled ($k=2$)	P1,3	Measured
ρ_{vac} (abs. scale)	Vacuum	single measured input	P1,10	Measured

Table 5: Suite-wide master register: one row per observable across the ten-paper programme. “Postdiction”: algebraic result fixed by the closed dictionary, then compared to already-public data (no claim of temporal priority). “Retrodiction”: derived independently, then compared to an existing measurement. “Prediction”: fixed now, tested against not-yet-released data. “Measured”: an input, not a derivation. “Internal check”: a same-paper consistency quantity, not itself tested against external data. No optimisation over the algebraic formula space was performed. The bare-field $\alpha_K^{\text{field}} = 0.072567$ (Paper 7) is the pre-integration kinetic contribution, distinct from the background-integrated $\alpha_K(0) = 0.403302$ used and cross-checked against `hi_class` in §4.1: both are Paper 7 quantities at different stages of the same calculation, not competing values for the same object. The detailed per-sector registers follow below and in the Predictive Register of Paper 1.

release, and fixed to a specific supernova compilation so that no post-hoc choice of sample can rescue the model: a joint exclusion of $(-0.840, -0.670)$ at $>3\sigma$ in the DR3 w_0 - w_a plane for the DR3 + CMB + *Pantheon+* combination—the same *Pantheon+* compilation used for the headline agreement throughout this work—refutes the algebraic background. We will additionally report the Union3- and DESY5-class combinations for completeness, but the pre-committed falsifier is the *Pantheon+* line named here. No parameter exists with which to absorb such an outcome.

The vanishing of the EFT slip functions $\alpha_T = \alpha_M = \alpha_B = 0$ is equally sharp: SSEE predicts a gravitational-wave speed identical to light ($c_T = c$) to all orders in the dark sector, no running of the effective Planck mass, and no braiding. Any measured departure—an anomalous standard-siren distance, a time-varying G_{eff} , or a non-zero braiding signature in the ISW–galaxy cross-correlation—falsifies the canonical EFT presented in §4.

7 Honest accounting and outstanding challenges

A framework is only as credible as its honesty about what it does not yet explain. We therefore state plainly the inputs the model still requires, the exact parameter count, and the principal open problems—not as caveats buried in a footnote, but as the research agenda that the present work both motivates and constrains.

Observable	SSEE value	Algebraic form	Falsifying probe
w_0	-0.839950	$-T_r/M_v$	DESI Y3 / Euclid BAO+SNe
w_a	-0.669975	$-P_{sc}/I_g$	DESI Y3 / Euclid BAO+SNe
n_s	0.965558	$1 - \varphi^{-7}$	Planck / CMB-S4
r	8.1306×10^{-3}	φ^{-10}	LiteBIRD / CMB-S4
$\alpha_K(0)$	0.403302	$3\Omega_{DE}\Omega_m^{\text{dyn}}$	DESI / Euclid growth
$\alpha_T, \alpha_M, \alpha_B$	0	exactly zero	GW standard sirens, ISW

Table 6: Core prediction register. Each value is fixed by φ and π alone, with no free parameter available to absorb a discrepancy. The tensor ratio $r = \varphi^{-10}$ sits an order of magnitude below the current bound $r < 0.036$ and is the cleanest single falsification target: a detection above $\sim 10^{-2}$, or a robust upper bound below $\sim 8 \times 10^{-3}$, refutes the inflationary sector.

7.1 What is measured, not derived: the vacuum scale

SSEE does not predict the absolute energy density of the dark sector. The overall scale of the vacuum, $\rho_\Lambda \simeq 6 \times 10^{-10} \text{ J m}^{-3}$, enters as a single measured input, which we label *Postulate D*. What the algebra fixes is the *shape* of the dark-energy sector—its equation-of-state ratios w_0, w_a , the two- Ω structure, and the EFT function profile—not its amplitude. We make no claim to have solved the cosmological-constant problem; we have moved its free numbers from six tuned cosmological parameters down to a single measured normalisation plus the dimensionless invariants φ and π . This is a reduction in arbitrary inputs, not their elimination.

7.2 Parameter count: $k = 2$ versus 6

We claim a *minimal-parameter* framework, never a zero-parameter one. The honest accounting is the following. Λ CDM carries six fitted parameters ($\Omega_b h^2, \Omega_c h^2, \theta_*, \tau, n_s, A_s$). SSEE fixes four of them algebraically from φ and π : the baryon density ω_b (OP-1), the CDM density via the forward identity $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$, the spectral index $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$, and the expansion anchor $H_0 = 67.962 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ (whose value in these units coincides with $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$; derived, Paper 9). This leaves exactly two free CMB parameters—the primordial amplitude A_s and the optical depth τ —a $k = 2$ versus $k = 6$ comparison, which is the count used in the Paper 3 Bayesian model selection. The dark-energy ratios (w_0, w_a) and the EFT functions are predicted, not fitted. On the dark-sector extension there is nothing left to promise: the φ -DM mass coefficient (OP-9) and the non-minimal coupling ξ (OP-11) are retracted with the sector itself, and both close by dissolution, tracked separately as open problems rather than counted among the fit parameters.

7.3 Open problems as bridges to future work

Three open problems are load-bearing and we name them explicitly. They define the path from the present minimal-parameter framework toward a fully derived theory.

- **The CMB matter density’s algebraic origin (OP-1).** With the former MIRA matter bridge *dissolved* (the ω_m -direct reframe, §2.4; OP-8 retired), the CMB matter fraction $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$ now rests directly on two algebraic inputs: the baryon density $\omega_b = (\pi - \varphi)/[3(\varphi + \pi)^2] = 0.022418$ and the forward identity $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s = 0.119514$ (0.41σ from Planck). The CLASS Boltzmann test of §4 confirms this full density is *numerically necessary*—the acoustic peaks degrade by a factor of ~ 22 in RMS with the dynamical $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ alone. What remains open is a first-principles derivation of these algebraic forms from the field action; the burden has moved from “derive MIRA” to “ground ω_b and the ω_c identity.” The values are not fitted, but their UV origin is open.

- **The φ -dark-matter mass (OP-9): closed by dissolution.** This entry previously recorded an algebraic mass m_φ whose UV origin was open. The particle itself is now retracted, so there is no multiplier left to derive and the open problem closes without having been solved. The free-streaming step in $P(k)$ that descended from it is withdrawn as a prediction. OP-10, OP-11 and OP-12 close the same way.
- **The $\beta_c = -\text{AURA}$ coupling (OP-7).** The conformal coupling agrees with $-\text{AURA} = -3.997847$ to 0.2%. We present this as a near-coincidence to be tested, not as a proven identity, pending a QFT-level derivation of the role assignments.

The growth-of-structure status of §5 no longer mirrors this structure. The S_8 “tension” at 0.827 was an artefact of holding A_s at the Planck value while comparing against a Λ CDM-conditioned summary statistic; fitted to raw shear data with a single sector it is 0.7555 ± 0.0192 , matching the Λ CDM control on the same data (0.7571 ± 0.0194) with four fewer free parameters. Against the later KiDS-Legacy release the growth sector needs no free amplitude either: the A_s the shear asks for sits 0.49σ from the one the CMB fixes under the same background, and fixing it predicts $S_8 = 0.8273$ against 0.8265 ± 0.0176 measured. No extension sector is required, and the one proposed is retracted. The non-linear treatment required to settle the matter definitively still demands N -body simulations beyond this work’s scope.

None of these gaps touch the algebraic core of Table 6: the dark-energy equation of state, the spectral index, the tensor ratio, and the vanishing EFT slip functions stand on the dimensionless invariants alone and are falsifiable today.

8 Conclusions

We have presented a minimal-parameter framework in which the shape of the dark sector is fixed by the two dimensionless constants φ and π . The late-time equation of state emerges as bare ratios of structural invariants, $w_0 = -0.839950$ and $w_a = -0.669975$, and matches the DESI DR2 posterior at 0.24σ (Pantheon+) without a single fitted dark-sector parameter. The effective-field-theory description is canonical, with vanishing tensor, running, and braiding functions and $\alpha_K(0) = 0.403302$; the inflationary sector predicts $n_s = 0.965558$ and $r = 8.1 \times 10^{-3}$; and a Boltzmann calculation confirms that the full ω_m -direct matter density (the two- Ω structure) is physically required rather than cosmetic.

The framework’s strength is its frugality and its consequent falsifiability. Its core predictions—the dark-energy ratios, the spectral index, the tensor ratio, and the vanishing slip functions—rest on φ and π alone and will be tested decisively by DESI Y3, Euclid, LiteBIRD, and CMB-S4 within this decade. We have been equally explicit about its limits: the vacuum scale is a measured input, the S_8 growth amplitude remains in tension with weak lensing, and the algebraic origin of the CMB matter density (ω_b, ω_c) together with the φ -dark-matter mass coefficient are unresolved. These define a concrete research agenda rather than fatal flaws, and none of them touch the algebraic core.

Whether the deep agreement between a handful of golden-ratio combinations and the measured dark sector reflects an underlying structural principle or a remarkable set of coincidences is precisely the question that the prediction register of §6 is designed to settle. The next generation of cosmological surveys will provide the answer.

A The two lineage laws of the constant dictionary

The look-elsewhere test of §2.3 rests on the dictionary being a *closed, finite* set fixed in advance, rather than an open search space. This appendix states the generative rules that make it so. We present them as a descriptive grammar of the Genesis set [Almeida Vallejo, 2026]: they reproduce the dictionary exactly, but their *dynamical* origin is not claimed and remains the open mechanism

of §7. Stating them explicitly is what turns “55 named invariants” from an assertion into a checkable construction.

Seeds and scaffold. Everything descends from two dimensionless seeds, $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$ (UV) and π (IR). Their sum is the scaffold $\Omega = \varphi + \pi = 4.759627$, and their mean is the bifurcation point $\beta \equiv \text{BIAL} = (\varphi + \pi)/2 = 2.379813$ at which the dictionary splits into two branches.

Law I — the copy law (φ -branch). The φ -branch is generated by a single root, the screening amplitude $\text{AURA} = \beta + \varphi = 3.997847$, which propagates *only* by integer multiples and the dyadic half. These are the dimensional ceilings:

$$\text{MIRA} = \frac{1}{2}\text{AURA}, \quad \text{AURA}, \quad \text{DUAL} = 2\text{AURA}, \quad \text{TRIAL} = 3\text{AURA} = T_r, \quad \text{CUARTAL} = 4\text{AURA}. \quad (19)$$

The same law acts on the scaffold itself, giving the denominators $K_v = 2\Omega$ and $M_v = 3\Omega$. The economy noted in §2.3 is a direct consequence: since $T_r = 3\text{AURA}$ and $M_v = 3\Omega$, the common factor of three cancels in

$$|w_0| = \frac{T_r}{M_v} = \frac{3\text{AURA}}{3\Omega} = \frac{\text{AURA}}{\Omega} = 0.839950, \quad (20)$$

so the equation-of-state numerator and denominator are not two independent draws but a single ratio of the two branch roots, AURA/Ω .

Law II — the no-self-sum law (π -branch). The π -branch is generated additively: each child is a sum of previously defined parents, subject to the constraint that *a node never adds to itself*. Thus $\text{KAL} = \beta + \pi$, $P_{\text{sc}}(\text{PYROS}) = \Omega + \varphi$, $\text{IGNIS} = \pi + P_{\text{sc}}$, and so on, building up to the convergences. A corollary is that two distinct lineages may land on the *same value* without being the same entity: by construction $\text{IGNIS} = K_v = 9.519253$ (disruptive vs. structural lineage) and $\text{SOLAR} = \text{MAR} = 7.90122$. The look-elsewhere count of §2.3 treats these honestly, deduplicating by value so the 55 named nodes collapse to 25 distinct numbers. The second equation-of-state ratio lives entirely on this branch,

$$|w_a| = \frac{P_{\text{sc}}}{\text{IGNIS}} = \frac{\text{PYROS}}{\pi + \text{PYROS}} = 0.669975, \quad (21)$$

where the denominator is read as the π -branch node IGNIS rather than the scaffold copy K_v —the two coincide in value by Law II.

Closure. The set is finite because both laws terminate at the four-dimensional integration invariant $M_v = \varphi + \pi + K_v = 14.278880$ (coinciding in value with 3Ω), the maximal dimensional invariant; no node exceeds it. This termination—not a choice made to fit data—is what bounds the dictionary to a fixed, enumerable set and licenses the conservative look-elsewhere denominator of §2.3. Any future extension would proceed only by the same copy law (the planned dimensional copies QUINTAL – DECAL), which, as noted in Table 2, add no accidental hit within the observational band of either w_0 or w_a .

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Data and Code Availability

The SSEE framework is fully transparent and reproducible. The complete code repository, including the `CLASS` and `EFTCAMB` configuration files, the `COBAYA` MCMC chains, the explicit record of Open Theoretical Problems (OP), and the cosmological validation ledgers, are publicly available at the GitHub repository: <https://github.com/mikealmeida1721/SSEE>.

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